

SYNOPTICS

SVKM's NMIMS
MUKESH PATEL SCH.OF TECH.MGMT ENGG-NM-M

Programme: B. Tech (AI)/B. Tech (AI & ML)/B. Tech (COMP)/B. Tech (CS)/B. Tech (CSE - CS)/B. Tech (DS)/B. Tech (EXTC)

Year: III/Semester VI(Exam Year: 2025-2026)

Subject: Elements of Project Management

Date: 16 May 2026

Time: 10:00 am to 01:00 pm (03:00 Hrs.)

Max. Marks: 100

FINAL EXAMINATION (Acad. Year:2025-2026)

Instructions:

1. This question paper contains 12 pages.
2. Answer to each new question to be started on a fresh page.
3. Figure in right hand side indicates full marks
4. Question No1 is compulsory
5. Out of remaining questions, attempt any 4 questions
6. In all 5 questions to be attempted
7. All questions carry equal marks
8. Standard Normal Cumulative Probability Table attached
9. Assume suitable data if necessary

Q1	Answer briefly:	[20]
a.	Describe the consequences of not using Project Management approach in managing medium and big size projects Answer: -DELAY -COST enhancement -WASTE OF RESOURCES -QUALITY DISSATISFACTION -REPUTATION get affected negatively	[04]
b.	Define ' Organization planning ' and describe functional/traditional organization structure Answer: -Organization planning is a process of identifying, documenting, and assigning project roles, responsibilities and reporting relationships - Traditional organizational structure is developed around the functional aspects of the organization like engineering, manufacturing, marketing, human resources, information systems - Traditional organization structure works best in small organizations in which the different sections are geographically close together and which provide only a small number of goods and/or services Definition: 02 Marks, Explanation: 02 Marks	[04]
c.	List the benefits of WBS-Work Breakdown Structures in project planning process Answer: 1. Tasks are definable or easily understood 2. Tasks becomes independent 3. Time & cost can be estimated easily 4. Progress becomes measurable 5. Tasks can be adaptable 6. Simplification in risk identification 7. Improved accountability	[04]

	8. Enhanced visibility Minimum four points: 04 Marks	
d.	Explain important risks that need to consider in Software development projects Answer: 1. Technical risks 2. Project management risks 3. Recourses risks 4. Stakeholder risks Minimum four risks with brief explanation for each risks: 04 Marks	[04]
e	List the types of project closure/termination Answer: 1. Termination by extinction 2. Termination by addition 3. Termination by integration 4. Termination by starvation Four types: 04 Marks	[04]
Q2		
a	“Analyze the relationship between project scope and feasibility. How do changes in one dimension affect the other? Support your explanation with examples. Answer: -PMBOK defines scope as “ sum of the products, services, and results to be provided as a project -In simple words, scope of project defines what needs to be accomplished within the project and outlines project boundaries, including what is included and what is excluded -Feasibility is the process of investigating a need, problem, and solutions in sufficient detail to determine if a solution is economically viable and worth developing -Project scope and feasibility are deeply interconnected dimensions in project management. -Changes in one almost always affect the other -Understanding this relationship helps project managers strike the right balance between ambition and practicality. A. When Scope Changes → Feasibility Changes 1. Increasing Scope can Reduce Feasibility 2. Decreasing Scope can Improve Feasibility B. When Feasibility Constraints Change → Scope Must Change 1. Budget Cuts Reduce Feasibility → Scope Must Be Reduced 2. New Technology or Skills Increase Feasibility → Scope Can Expand Definition of scope and feasibility: 02 Marks Explanation with relationship between scope and feasibility: 05 Marks Example: 03 Marks	[10]
b	“Analyze the impact of project managers’ formal qualifications and informal qualifications on the success of mega/big projects, highlighting which informal qualifications appears more influential.” Answer: - Mega or large-scale projects such as infrastructure, IT systems, and industrial projects are characterized by high complexity, long durations, multiple stakeholders, and significant uncertainty -The success of such projects is strongly influenced by the qualifications of the project manager (PM), which can be classified into formal and informal qualifications 1. Impact of Formal Qualifications	[10]

	-Formal qualifications refer to structured and certified knowledge acquired through education and training, These include: -Academic degrees in engineering, management, or related fields -Professional certifications (PMP, PRINCE2, Agile certifications, etc.) -Formal training in project management tools and methodologies Positive impact on mega projects: -Formal qualifications provide PMs with a systematic understanding of project management processes, including scope, cost, time, quality, risk, and procurement management - They enable the use of standardized frameworks, tools, and techniques, which are necessary for planning, monitoring, and controlling large projects -Certified PMs are better equipped to ensure compliance with organizational, contractual, and regulatory requirements, which are critical in mega projects Limitations: - Formal qualifications alone often do not address human, political, and cultural complexities inherent in large projects -Knowledge-based competency may be insufficient when facing unexpected crises, stakeholder conflicts, or leadership challenges 2. Impact of Informal Qualifications -Informal qualifications emerge through experience and personal attributes rather than formal education, These include: • Leadership and decision-making ability • Communication and negotiation skills • Emotional intelligence and adaptability • Practical experience and lessons learned from past projects • Stakeholder and conflict management capability Positive impact on mega projects: -Informal qualifications help PMs manage diverse stakeholders, including clients, contractors, regulators, and communities. -Strong leadership and interpersonal skills enable PMs to motivate large teams, resolve conflicts, and build trust -Experience-based intuition allows project managers to anticipate risks and respond effectively to uncertainties that are common in mega projects -Informal competencies support context-specific decision making, which rigid methodologies cannot always address 3. Comparative Analysis and Influence on Project Success When analyzing the relative influence of both qualifications: -Formal qualifications are crucial during the planning, structuring, and control phases, ensuring technical and procedural rigor -Informal qualifications play a dominant role during execution and crisis situations, where leadership, communication, and judgment are critical -Evidence from project failures and successes shows that mega projects often fail not due to lack of technical knowledge, but due to weak leadership, poor stakeholder management, and ineffective communication therefor informal qualifications tend to have a greater influence on overall project success. Impact of formal qualification: 03 Marks Impact of Informal qualification: 03 Marks qualifikation important/affects success of project: 04 Marks Why informal	
Q3		
a	Define ‘ Quality Planning ’ and explain in detail as part of project planning process	[10]

	Answer: -Quality planning is defined as “The process of identifying quality requirements and/or standards for the project and its deliverables and documenting how the project will demonstrate compliance with quality requirements” - Quality planning is an integral part of the project planning phase and forms the foundation for quality assurance and quality control Quality Planning as Part of the Project Planning Process: -Quality planning translates stakeholder expectations into measurable quality requirements and embeds them into the project execution strategy -It focuses on doing the work right the first time Key Activities Involved in Quality Planning 1. Identification of Quality Requirements -Customer specifications, regulatory requirements, industry standards (ISO, Six Sigma, etc.) are identified. -Stakeholder expectations regarding performance, reliability, safety, and durability are clearly defined. 2. Establishment of Quality Standards and Metrics -Quality standards provide reference benchmarks for performance. -Measurable quality metrics such as defect rate, tolerance limits, or performance indices are established. 3. Selection of Quality Tools and Techniques -Tools such as checklists, flowcharts, cause-and-effect diagrams, benchmarking, and cost-benefit analysis are selected. -These tools help in preventing defects rather than correcting them later. 4. Integration with Other Project Plans -Quality planning is aligned with scope, schedule, cost, and risk management plans. -Trade-offs between quality, time, and cost are evaluated. 5. Documentation of Quality Plan -A Quality Management Plan is prepared documenting standards, responsibilities, processes, and review procedures. Roles of the project team and quality responsibilities are clearly defined <table><tr><th>Inputs required for Quality Planning</th><th>Output of Quality Planning</th></tr><tr><td> -Project scope statement -Stakeholder requirements -Organizational process assets -Applicable regulations and standards </td><td> -Quality Management Plan -Quality metrics -Process improvement plans -Updated project documents </td></tr><tr><td colspan="2">Definition: 02 Marks, Key Activities: 05 Marks Input and Output of Quality Planning process: 03 Marks</td></tr></table>	Inputs required for Quality Planning	Output of Quality Planning	-Project scope statement -Stakeholder requirements -Organizational process assets -Applicable regulations and standards	-Quality Management Plan -Quality metrics -Process improvement plans -Updated project documents	Definition: 02 Marks, Key Activities: 05 Marks Input and Output of Quality Planning process: 03 Marks		
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b	Analyze the uses and significance of risk register in relation to project risk planning & implementation of response to risks in medium size and big/mega projects Answer: -Risk register is a document that contains the results of various risk management processes and that is often displayed in a table or spreadsheet format -Risk register is a tool for documenting potential risk events and related information -In other words Risk Register is a central document in project risk management that records all identified risks, their characteristics, ownership, planned responses, and current status -In medium-size and big/mega projects, where uncertainty, complexity, and stakeholder involvement are high, the risk register plays a critical role in both risk planning and implementation of risk responses	[10]						

	<u>Key Uses in Risk Planning</u> -Systematic Risk Identification: The risk register captures all identified risks, including their sources and categories (technical, financial, legal, environmental, etc.), ensuring no major risk area is overlooked -Risk Analysis and Prioritization: Each risk is assessed for probability and impact, allowing prioritization. In big and mega projects, this helps focus management attention and resources on high-exposure risks -Decision-making Support: By linking risks to project objectives (cost, time, scope, quality), the risk register supports informed trade-off analysis during planning. -Planning for Risk Ownership: Assignment of risk owners ensures accountability, which is essential in medium and large projects with multiple functional teams. <u>Significance in Large Projects</u> In mega projects, incomplete or informal risk planning often results in cost overruns and delays. A detailed risk register provides visibility and traceability, making risk planning more realistic and proactive Beyond planning, the risk register becomes an active control instrument during project execution. <u>Key Uses in Risk Response Implementation</u> -Link between Risks and Responses: The register documents response strategies (avoid, mitigate, transfer, accept) along with contingency and fallback plans, enabling systematic implementation. -Monitoring Response Effectiveness: Risk status (open, closed, escalated) is regularly updated, allowing project managers to analyze whether response actions are effective or need revision. -Early Warning Mechanism: In medium and large projects, changes in risk indicators help in early detection of emerging threats, preventing escalation into crises. -Management of Secondary Risks: Implementation of responses often creates new risks. The risk register ensures these secondary risks are identified and analyzed promptly <u>Significance of Risk Register</u> -Without a risk register, risk management remains reactive and fragmented -With a well-maintained register, risk management becomes continuous, transparent, and measurable - It acts as a living document, linking planning assumptions with real-time execution outcomes Introduction to risk register: 02 Marks Key uses in risk planning: 03 Marks Key uses in risk implementation: 03 Marks Significance: 02 Marks												
Q4													
a	Activity data for PERT network is given in following table: <table><tr><th rowspan="2">Activity</th><th colspan="3">Estimated duration (in weeks)</th></tr><tr><th>Optimistic T_O</th><th>Mostlikely T_M</th><th>Pessimistic T_P</th></tr><tr><td>1-2</td><td>1</td><td>1</td><td>7</td></tr></table>	Activity	Estimated duration (in weeks)			Optimistic T _O	Mostlikely T _M	Pessimistic T _P	1-2	1	1	7	[12]
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	<table> <tr><td>1-3</td><td>1</td><td>4</td><td>7</td></tr> <tr><td>1-4</td><td>2</td><td>2</td><td>8</td></tr> <tr><td>2-5</td><td>1</td><td>1</td><td>1</td></tr> <tr><td>3-5</td><td>2</td><td>5</td><td>14</td></tr> <tr><td>4-6</td><td>2</td><td>5</td><td>8</td></tr> <tr><td>5-6</td><td>3</td><td>6</td><td>15</td></tr> </table> 1. Sketch the network diagram 2. Determine critical path and total duration of the project 3. Determine Latest start and Latest finish time for all activities 4. Evaluate the probability of project completion at least 4 weeks earlier than expected 5. If the project due in 19 weeks, evaluate the probability of meeting the due date? Answers: 1. Network diagram: 02 Marks 2. Determine critical path and total duration of the project :03 Marks 3. Determine Latest start and Latest finish time for all activities: 03 Marks 4. Evaluate the probability of project completion at least 4 weeks earlier than expected 9.18% : 02 Marks 5. If the project due in 19 weeks, evaluate the probability of meeting the due date? 74.86% : 02 Marks	1-3	1	4	7	1-4	2	2	8	2-5	1	1	1	3-5	2	5	14	4-6	2	5	8	5-6	3	6	15	
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b	Explain in detail types of risks when one studies risk management as a part of project management Answer: 1. Technical Risks 2. Social Risks 3. Economic Risks 4. Political Risks 5. Production Risks 6. Marketing Risks 7. Financial Risks 8. Human Risks 9. Positive Risks 10. Negative Risks Five to six types of risks with brief explanation for each risk: 08Marks	[08]																								
Q5																										
a	Explain importance of project life cycle in detail when one studies project management Answer: -The project life cycle serves to define the beginning and the end of a project (Each project has a starting point and progresses toward a predetermined conclusion) -Project life cycle is series of phases of a project from initiation to completion/closure - Common phases include initiation, planning, execution including monitoring & control, and closure -Understanding the project life cycle is essential when studying project management, as it provides a systematic framework for managing projects effectively Importance: 1. Provides a Structured Approach to Project Management 2. Enhances Planning and Control 3. Improves Risk Identification and Management 4. Supports Effective Decision-Making	[08]																								

	5. Facilitates Clear Role Definition and Responsibility 6. Ensures Quality and Stakeholder Satisfaction -The project life cycle is fundamental to the study of project management as it provides a structured, phased, and systematic approach to planning, executing, and controlling projects -Project Life Cycle enhances decision-making, risk management, resource utilization, and overall project success, making it an essential concept for effective project management practice Definition of PLC: 02 Marks Importance: 06 Marks Explanation of	
b	Define WBS- Work Breakdown Structures and examine following statement “Components or full project failures, when they do occurs, can often be traced to a poorly developed or nonexistent WBS” Answer: -PMBOK defines Work Breakdown Structures as a deliverable oriented grouping of activities that organizes and defines the total scope of project -WBS forms the foundation for effective project planning, execution, and control -The given statement highlights the critical role of WBS in preventing project failures 1. Role of WBS in Defining Project Scope A well-developed WBS ensures that all project deliverables and activities are clearly identified. If the WBS is poorly developed or missing: • Important tasks may be omitted • Scope becomes unclear or incomplete This often leads to component failures, as certain required outputs are never planned or executed properly. 2. Impact on Cost and Schedule Estimation The WBS is the basis for accurate time and cost estimation. Without a proper WBS: • Efforts are underestimated or duplicated • Resource allocation becomes inefficient As a result, projects face schedule delays and cost overruns, which are common causes of overall project failure. 3. Effect on Responsibility and Accountability Each work package in a WBS is usually assigned to a responsible individual or team. In the absence of a clear WBS: • Responsibilities are poorly defined • Tasks fall through gaps or are assumed to be someone else’s responsibility This lack of accountability often causes partial or full project failures. 4. Influence on Risk Identification and Control A detailed WBS helps in identifying risks at the activity or component level. A weak or non-existent WBS limits visibility into potential problem areas, making risk management reactive rather than proactive. This increases the chances of unforeseen failures. 5. Impact on Monitoring and Control Performance measurement tools such as progress tracking and earned value analysis depend on a structured WBS. Without it: • Progress cannot be accurately measured • Deviations are detected too late This leads to loss of control and eventually project failure. -The statement is valid because a poorly developed or non-existent WBS undermines almost every aspect of project management, including scope definition, estimation, responsibility assignment, risk management, and control. Consequently, many component-level and full project failures can indeed be traced back to weaknesses in the	[08]

	WBS -Therefore, a well-structured WBS is essential for successful project execution. Definition: 02 Marks Explanation: 06 Marks	
c	Relate Tuckman's model of team building and building project team in project management Answer: -Tuckman's model of team building explains how teams develop through distinct stages, namely Forming, Storming, Norming, Performing, and Adjourning -This model closely relates to the process of building and managing a project team in project management 1. Forming Stage and Project Team Formation In project management, the forming stage corresponds to team acquisition and orientation. Team members come together, roles and responsibilities are introduced, and project objectives are explained. The project manager plays a key role by providing direction and establishing expectations. 2. Storming Stage and Team Development Challenges During this stage, conflicts may arise due to differences in opinions, work styles, or misunderstood roles. In project teams, this is common when members start working on tasks. The project manager must apply conflict management and communication skills to resolve issues and keep the team focused on project goals. 3. Norming Stage and Team Cohesion As the project progresses, team members begin to cooperate, trust each other, and accept their roles. In this stage, project teams develop effective working relationships, follow defined processes, and improve coordination, enhancing overall project performance. 4. Performing Stage and Project Execution In the performing stage, the project team operates at high efficiency and productivity. Members are motivated and capable of handling tasks independently. This stage aligns with successful project execution, where the team delivers project outputs with minimal supervision. 5. Adjourning Stage and Project Closure At project completion, the team is disbanded, and members move on to new assignments. The project manager ensures proper project closure, documentation, and recognition of team efforts, consistent with the adjourning stage. -Tuckman's model provides a useful framework for understanding team behaviour during different stages of a project -By relating these stages to building a project team, project managers can apply appropriate leadership and management strategies, thereby improving team effectiveness and project success. Five stage of model and mapping with project team building: 04 Marks	[04]
Q6		
a	Define 'Quantitative Risk' and Explain 'Identify risks' as one of the seven processes in risk management in project Answer: -Quantitative risk refers to the process of assigning numerical values to potential risks, using data and statistical methods to assess the probability of a risk occurring and its potential impact on a project's cost, schedule, or scope, essentially translating the risk into measurable terms -According to PMBOK (Project Management Body of Knowledge), Identify Risks is one of the seven key processes of Project Risk Management <u>Identify Risks' Process in Project Risk Management (PMBOK-Aligned)</u>	[08]

	Purpose of the Process The primary purpose of Identify Risks is to recognize all potential events or conditions that could positively or negatively impact project objectives such as scope, time, cost, quality, and performance. Inputs Used for Risk Identification This process uses important project documents such as the project charter, project management plan, scope baseline, schedule, cost estimates, stakeholder register, and historical information from similar projects. Techniques for Identifying Risks PMBOK recommends techniques such as expert judgment, brainstorming, interviews, checklists, SWOT analysis, and document review. These techniques help systematically identify a wide range of potential risks. Stakeholder and Team Involvement Risk identification involves project team members, stakeholders, subject-matter experts, and sponsors. Their experience and perspectives increase the accuracy and completeness of identified risks. Risk Register as Output The main output of this process is the Risk Register, which includes a list of identified risks along with their causes, potential impacts, and initial risk owners. This register becomes a key document for subsequent risk processes. Continuous and Iterative Nature PMBOK emphasizes that Identify Risks is not a one-time activity. It is performed throughout the project as new risks may emerge and existing risks may change over time. Definition: 02 Marks Explanation: 06Marks	
b	List the reasons for carry out the estimation of project costs Answer: Project cost estimation is carried out for the following key reasons: To Assess Project Feasibility Cost estimation helps determine whether the project is financially viable and affordable before it is approved and executed. To Prepare the Project Budget Estimated costs provide the basis for developing the project budget and establishing a cost baseline. To Support Planning and Resource Allocation Cost estimates assist in planning manpower, materials, equipment, and other resources efficiently. To Control and Monitor Project Costs Estimated costs serve as a reference to compare actual expenditures, enabling control of cost overruns and timely corrective actions. Four reasons with brief explanation for each reason: 04 Marks	[04]
c	Explain with reasons which project cost estimation model is suitable for medium size and big software projects/IT-Information technology projects Answer: -For medium-size and large software projects, estimation models must handle complexity, multiple components, technology factors, and team productivity. Among the various models available, COCOMO (Constructive Cost Model)—especially Intermediate and Detailed COCOMO, and Function Point Analysis (FPA) are considered most suitable	[08]

	<u>Reasons-</u> 1. COCOMO Model (Intermediate and Detailed) COCOMO is highly suitable for medium and big projects because it is based on empirical data and considers multiple cost drivers. Reasons for suitability: • Intermediate COCOMO includes cost drivers such as product complexity, hardware constraints, personnel capability, and project environment, which are critical in medium and large projects. • Detailed COCOMO further divides the project into modules and estimates effort phase-wise (design, coding, testing), which improves accuracy for large-scale systems. • It helps in analyzing trade-offs between cost, schedule, and manpower, which is essential for complex projects. Well-suited for projects with relatively stable and well-defined requirements 2. Function Point Analysis (FPA) FPA is another widely used model for medium and big software projects, especially business and enterprise applications. Reasons for suitability: • Estimation is based on functional requirements, not lines of code, making it technology-independent. • Suitable for projects with changing technologies or mixed programming environments. • Allows early estimation during the requirement analysis phase, useful for large projects where early planning is critical. • Supports better comparison and benchmarking across projects. Any one correct model with reasons: 08 Marks	
Q7		
a	List and briefly explain steps to avoid negative consequences of project termination/closure Answer: -Project termination or closure, if not handled properly, can lead to financial loss, stakeholder dissatisfaction, legal issues, and loss of organizational learning. <u>Steps to avoid or minimize negative consequences:</u> 1. Formal Project Closure Documentation Officially document the reasons for termination or completion, approval from management, and closure decisions. This avoids ambiguity and future disputes regarding the project status. 2. Clear Communication to Stakeholders All stakeholders, including clients, team members, suppliers, and sponsors, should be informed clearly and timely about the project closure to avoid confusion, rumors, or dissatisfaction. 3. Financial Settlement and Account Closure Ensure proper settlement of all financial matters such as payments to vendors, contractors, and staff. Unused funds should be returned, and accounts should be formally closed. 4. Proper Resource Release and Reassignment Project resources (human, equipment, and facilities) should be released in a planned manner and reassigned to other projects to avoid idle resources and employee dissatisfaction. 5. Documentation of Lessons Learned Capture and document lessons learned, including reasons for success or failure,	[08]

	so that similar mistakes are avoided in future projects and organizational learning is enhanced. 6. Completion of Legal and Contractual Obligations Review and close all contracts, ensure compliance with legal requirements, and obtain formal acceptance where required to prevent legal complications. 7. Secure and Archive Project Records All project documents, reports, designs, and data should be properly archived for future reference, audits, or legal needs. 8. Post-Project Review and Evaluation Conduct a post-termination or post-project review to assess performance, identify gaps, and suggest improvements for future project management practices. Proper steps with brief explanation of each step: 08Marks	
b	"A project budget is a key tool for cost control and decision-making in project management particularly in medium size and big/mega projects" Explain Answer: <u>Importance of Project Budget as a Tool for Cost Control and Decision Making in Project Management:</u> -A project budget is a detailed financial plan that estimates the total cost required to complete a project within a defined scope and time -In medium-size and large/mega projects, budgeting plays a critical role in effective cost control and managerial decision-making due to the scale, complexity, and resource intensity involved. 1. Foundation for Cost Planning and Control The project budget provides a baseline against which actual costs are measured. By comparing planned and actual expenditures, project managers can identify cost overruns early and apply corrective actions. This is especially important in large projects where small deviations can lead to significant financial losses. 2. Supports Informed Decision-Making A well-prepared budget helps management evaluate different alternatives such as technology selection, outsourcing decisions, scheduling options, and resource allocation. In mega projects, decisions like adding manpower, changing suppliers, or re-scoping work are guided by budgetary impact analysis. 3. Efficient Resource Allocation Budgets ensure optimal utilization of resources such as labor, materials, equipment, and subcontractors. In medium and large projects with multiple activities running in parallel, budgeting helps prioritize critical tasks and prevents wasteful spending. 4. Risk Management and Contingency Planning Large projects face higher uncertainty and risks. Budgeting includes contingency reserves for unforeseen events such as delays, price escalation, or technical issues, helping maintain financial stability throughout the project lifecycle. 5. Performance Measurement and Control Budgets enable the use of cost control tools such as variance analysis and earned value management (EVM) to assess project performance. This improves accountability and transparency in large project environments. 6. Stakeholder Confidence and Financial Discipline A realistic and controlled budget enhances confidence among stakeholders, sponsors, and investors. It demonstrates financial discipline, which is crucial for approval, funding continuity, and long-term organizational credibility. -In medium-size and big/mega projects, the project budget acts as a central tool for planning, monitoring, and controlling costs while supporting	[08]

	strategic and operational decision-making - Hence effective budgeting is essential for successful project completion within approved cost constraints Minimum four to five points with explanation: 08 Marks	
c	Compare traditional/conventional project management approach with system approach for project management Answer: Four to five points of comparison: 04 Marks	[04]